

# OBOOK Holdings, Inc. Class A (OWLS)

OwlTing Group Poised to Enter Execution Phase of Stablecoin Payments Strategy Aimed at Capturing Demand for Compliant, Cross-Border Rails; Initiating Coverage at Buy with \$11 PT

**Initiation of Coverage**

**Rating: Buy**

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► **We are initiating coverage of OBOOK Holdings, Inc. (OWLS), which operates as OwlTing Group, with a Buy rating and a price target of \$11.** OWLS has emerged as a compelling small-cap way to play the mainstreaming of stablecoin payments, as it is aiming to serve as the regulated operating layer between fiat money and stablecoin settlement. The company has money-transmission coverage across 41 U.S. states, a Virtual Asset Service Provider (VASP) license in the EU, a banking-API-related license in Japan, integration into Circle Payments Network (CPN) (CRCL, Not Rated) as an Originating Financial Institution, and, crucially, an expanding collaboration with Visa (V, Not Rated) that now includes debit-card-funded USDC stablecoin purchases through OwlPay. We believe that if OWLS can demonstrate that signed clients and enabled corridors are translating into recurring revenue, then investors may start valuing it less like a transitional low-margin payments company and more like stablecoin infrastructure with a durable growth trajectory.

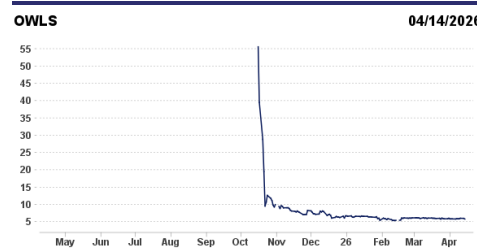
► **Moving up the value stack from gateway economics toward infrastructure economics.** OWLS is executing a strategic pivot from its e-commerce roots toward the "boring" but highly lucrative infrastructure of stablecoin settlement, on/off-ramps, and compliance-embedded payment services. The company is taking direct aim at the high-fee, slow-speed incumbents targeting the \$230bn U.S. outbound remittance market with near-instant settlement at a fraction of the cost incurred by legacy providers. The consumer-facing OwlPay Cash App promotes stablecoin adoption by letting everyday U.S. debit card users fund USDC wallets instantly within OWLS' ecosystem while powering outbound remittances at up to 70% lower costs than legacy SWIFT rails.

► **Visa Direct partnership provides immediate, scalable user base.** Visa Direct brings OWLS access to 11bn+ endpoints, 160 currencies, and 195+ countries and territories. This integration effectively turns every Visa debit card into a gateway for stablecoin liquidity while providing OWLS with an immediate, scalable user base that legacy crypto-native firms struggle to reach due to onboarding friction. Moreover, by leveraging Visa Direct, OWLS eliminates the multi-day waiting periods inherent in the SWIFT system and allows for cross-border transactions to be settled in real-time.

► **Commercial traction beginning to show up in ways that matter.** OWLS needs to prove that enterprises want compliant fiat-to-stablecoin-to-fiat infrastructure, and the early evidence has been encouraging. The company announced that during 1Q26 it signed and onboarded over 20 enterprise clients to OwlPay Harbor, including signed agreements and active onboarding processes, and that the annual payment volume represented by those clients' existing businesses exceeds \$5bn. The named clients span Fintech, remittance, nonprofit, and cross-border B2B categories, with corridors from the United States into Latin America, Africa, the Middle East, and Asia-Pacific.

► **Valuation.** Our \$11 price target for OWLS is based on a 5x EV/revenue multiple applied to our FY28E revenue of \$200.3m.

## Price Chart



|                         |                  |
|-------------------------|------------------|
| Current Price           | \$5.77           |
| Price Target            | \$11.00          |
| 52-Week Range           | \$5.15 - \$90.00 |
| Market Cap (mm)         | \$510            |
| Shares Outstanding (mm) | 82               |
| Sector Weight           | Overweight       |

|                        | Year to 31 Dec | 1Q25A | 2Q25A | 3Q25E | 4Q25E | 2025E     | 2026E      | 2027E       |
|------------------------|----------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-----------|------------|-------------|
| EPS                    |                |       |       |       |       | (0.30)    | (0.09)     | 0.26        |
| Delta % (+/-) v. Cons. |                |       |       |       |       |           |            |             |
| Revenue (m)            |                |       |       |       |       | \$7,908.6 | \$37,621.7 | \$104,782.7 |

## Company Overview

OBOOK Holdings, Inc. (Nasdaq: OWLS), which operates as OwlTing Group, traces its roots to Taiwan in 2010 when it was founded by Darren Wang and John Hsieh. What began as a series of e-commerce and hospitality ventures including OwlTing Market for Taiwanese agricultural products, OwlNest property management software, and OwlJourney online travel agency has evolved into a platform focused on stablecoin payments infrastructure. The company's Nasdaq direct listing in October 2025 provided it with the visibility and capital access needed to scale globally while retaining its founder-led, engineering-first culture.

OWLS operates in three primary business segments, each at a different stage of maturity and strategic priority. The company's Payments segment, anchored by the OwlPay platform, is the company's growth engine and primary focus of its capital allocation. Its Hospitality segment, operating under the OwlNest brand, is a mature, cash-generative SaaS business that provides property management, channel management, and booking engine software to hotels and hospitality operators across Asia. OWLS' E-Commerce segment, operated through its marketplace platform, is a legacy business that management has strategically de-emphasized, reallocating resources toward payments infrastructure.

### Payments Segment

OwlPay is OWLS' flagship product family and the centerpiece of its long-term strategy. The Web2 and Web3 hybrid payment solution was designed to enable global businesses to operate confidently in the expanding stablecoin economy. The platform encompasses several distinct product lines that together form a complete stablecoin payment infrastructure stack.

## OwlTing's Business Segments



### Growth Engine: Payments (OwlPay)

- Full-stack suite – OwlPay Payment, OwlPay Wallet Pro, OwlPay Harbor
- Supports fiat & stablecoin (USDC, EURC, ZUSD, GYEN) transactions



### Stable Recurring Revenue: Hospitality (SaaS)

- OwlNest PMS – blockchain-based property management system
- OTA platforms – OwlJourney, OwlTing Experiences; offline platform OwlStay



### Incubator: E-commerce

- OwlTing Market – farm-to-consumer platform in Taiwan, connecting local producers to global markets

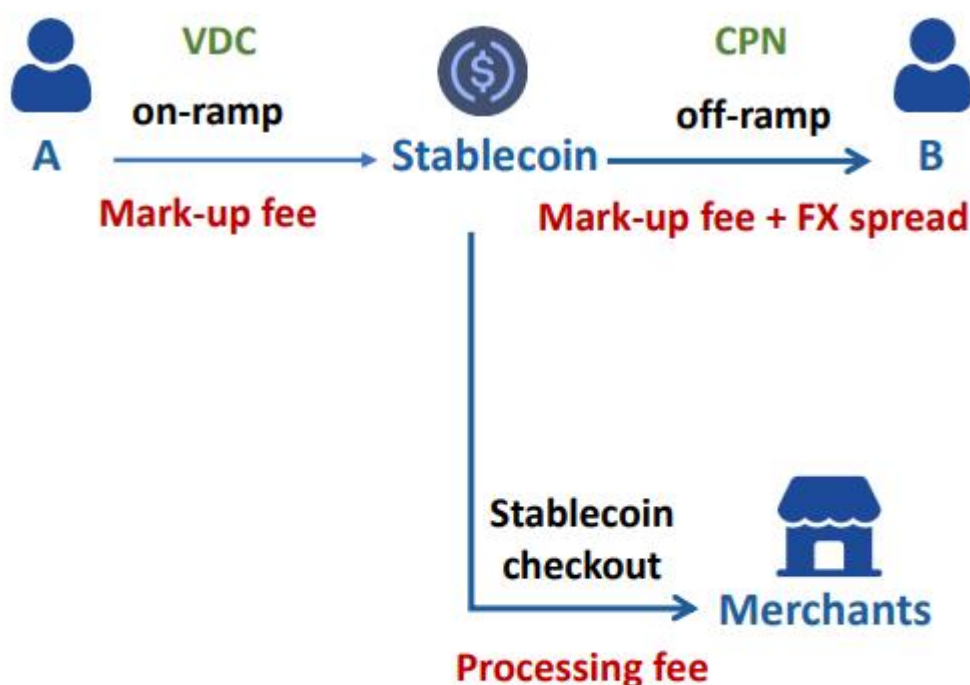
*Source: Company presentation*

*OwlPay Harbor*, OWLS' flagship enterprise B2B settlement product, operates as a global digital currency payment infrastructure that enables enterprise clients to convert fiat currency into regulated digital currencies (primarily USDC) and settle cross-border transactions through major distributed ledger rails.

OWLS' enterprise clients onboarded to Harbor complete API integration and compliance onboarding, after which the company becomes their settlement infrastructure counterparty for cross-border flows. The platform generally monetizes through transaction-based fees, with the company citing a blended take rate of 25-35bps across settlement, FX, and embedded compliance services. Management notes that OWLS' blended take rate is consistent with global enterprise settlement benchmarks.

OWLS' 1Q26 announcement that OwlPay Harbor had signed and onboarded over 20 enterprise clients representing aggregate annual payment volumes exceeding \$5bn across their existing businesses marked the first concrete signal that the activation phase management had promised for 2026 was arriving ahead of schedule. Among the clients named were Graph (Oval Technologies [Private]), a platform enabling African businesses to settle cross-border B2B import payments from the United States, and Dexpay (Private), an Africa-focused fintech helping businesses on- and off-ramp international payments through regional telecom networks.

### OwlTing's Revenue Model



*Revenue expansion is driven by repeat settlement activity rather than incremental sales or marketing spend*

*Source: Company Presentation*

OwlPay Wallet Pro is OWLS' institutional digital wallet infrastructure, powered by MPC-based custody architecture and integrated into the Circle Payments Network (CPN). The company operates within CPN as an Originating Financial Institution, meaning it can initiate cross-border stablecoin transactions directly from its own infrastructure, a status that gives it access to CPN's global settlement network covering corridors across the U.S., China, Hong Kong, Latin America, Africa, India, Japan, Korea, Dubai, and the EU. The wallet supports intelligent routing of stablecoin payments, automatically optimizing for exchange rates, fees, and service availability in real time. Compared with traditional correspondent banking, the settlement experience is materially faster, more cost-efficient, and less operationally complex.

*OwlPay Cash* is OWLS' consumer-facing product, launched in February in collaboration with Visa Direct. The mobile-first remittance application enables U.S.-based users to send funds directly to bank accounts in 26 countries across Latin America, Asia, and Europe, combining global reach, transparent FX pricing, and no monthly fees. The application targets the approximately \$230bn U.S. outbound remittance economy in which legacy providers such as Western Union (WU, Not Rated) and MoneyGram (MGI, Not Rated) have long dominated with historically high fees. By combining CPN for stablecoin settlement on the sending side with Visa Direct's 11bn+ endpoint reach for last-mile fiat delivery, OwlPay Cash enables real-time payouts in local currencies at up to 70% lower cost than traditional SWIFT-based methods. The product positions OWLS as a challenger in a market with structural tailwinds driven by increasing digital payment adoption across key remittance corridors.

*OwlPay Checkout*, OWLS' most forward-looking product, was announced in January in connection with the company's integration into Coinbase's (COIN, Buy, \$267 PT) x402 ecosystem. The x402 protocol is an open standard designed to enable AI agents to initiate payments natively across the web. OwlPay Checkout is designed to provide the critical merchant-side infrastructure for receiving such payments, essentially serving as the digital cash register to the x402 protocol's digital wallet. While agentic commerce remains nascent, McKinsey estimated the global market opportunity at \$3-5tn by 2030, driven by AI agents capable of autonomous purchasing decisions. OWLS' compliance stack, regulatory licenses, and settlement rails position it to be an infrastructure layer through which AI-initiated payments are verified, settled, and distributed to merchants.

### Hospitality Segment

While OwlPay dominates OWLS' strategic narrative, the OwlNest hospitality technology platform provides a stable revenue foundation and a strategic distribution channel. OwlNest is a cloud-based property management system and channel management solution serving over 2,700 subscribing hotel and hospitality operators across Asia, with particular penetration in Taiwan and Southeast Asia. The platform generates recurring subscription-based revenue that grew ~20% yoy in 1H25. Management views OwlNest not only as a revenue stream but as a natural distribution channel for OwlPay, as hospitality operators have high-frequency, recurring cross-border payment needs, all of which are natural candidates for stablecoin-based settlement.

### Incubator: E-Commerce Segment

E-commerce is OWLS' oldest business segment, predating the company's eventual pivot toward payments and stablecoin infrastructure. At its core is OwlTing Market, an e-commerce platform designed to connect local Taiwanese farmers and merchants with their customers. The platform was built around a deliberately curated supply base, as founder Darren Wang personally selected each vendor and set a strict standard under which products with additives, artificial coloring, or flavoring cannot be sold on it.

That exacting approach, though operationally demanding, proved effective at building a differentiated marketplace. It identified more than 1,500 farmers and merchants in Taiwan alone, and the business captured recurring consumer interest, with more than 20% of customers becoming repeat subscribers and a customer retention rate of 70%, with users returning on average every two weeks to place orders. Unlike most e-commerce platforms that charge annual listing fees, OwlTing Market charges farmers zero annual fees and collects only a low commission on each completed sale.

The e-commerce segment's technological foundation has been a key differentiator. In 2017, OwlTing launched OwlChain, the world's first Ethereum-based food provenance system, integrating blockchain technology into its supply chain infrastructure through partnerships with vendors including Nice Garden and Upwelling Ocean. Through OwlChain, products sold on OwlTing Market are fully traceable to the source, allowing customers to access information about producers, certified authorities, and product origins. While the e-commerce segment today plays a supporting role to OwlPay as the company's strategic growth engine, it continues to function as a real-world proving ground for the payments infrastructure OWLS is building at scale.

## Overview of Stablecoin Payment Space

The stablecoin payments space has transitioned from a period of speculative volatility and regulatory ambiguity to one characterized by institutional integration and statutory maturity. With a market capitalization of almost \$320bn and annual transaction volumes reaching the trillions, stablecoins have moved beyond their original role as trading collateral for crypto exchanges to become a legitimate, high-velocity layer of global payment infrastructure.

The most significant driver of the current stablecoin outlook is the pivot by traditional financial incumbents. For much of the early 2020s, legacy payment rails viewed blockchain-based assets with skepticism or as a niche threat. However, by mid-2025, the narrative shifted



toward collaboration. Major fintech players like PayPal (PYPL, Not Rated), with its PYUSD stablecoin, and Stripe (Private), which fully reintegrated stablecoin payments for merchants in late 2024, have proven the utility of programmable money.

The integration of stablecoins into platforms like Zelle, which recently explored incorporating stablecoin transfers across member banks, signals that the friction of the "last mile" is being addressed. Stablecoins are no longer isolated within digital wallets, as they are being woven into the fabric of retail and commercial banking. Visa's Onchain Analytics noted that, as of late 2025, adjusted stablecoin settlement volumes surpassed \$2.5tn annually, a tenfold increase from 2020. This growth is driven by businesses seeking the efficiency of T+0 (near-instant) settlement and lower transaction costs compared to traditional SWIFT or ACH networks.

For years, the primary headwind for stablecoin adoption was the lack of a clear legal framework. This changed dramatically in June 2025 with the passage of the Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for U.S. Stablecoins (GENIUS) Act. By establishing a federal licensing framework and explicitly stating that payment stablecoins are neither securities nor commodities, the legislation provided the legal certainty that banks and large corporations needed to hold these assets on their balance sheets.

In Europe, the Markets in Crypto-Assets (MiCA) regulation has played a similar role, setting the gold standard for reserve transparency and consumer protection. These regulations have effectively ended the "Wild West" era of algorithmic stablecoins, which collapsed with the Terra/Luna debacle in May 2022, while bringing about a flight to quality in which users prioritize tokens with safe, liquid reserve compositions.

The most profound impact of stablecoins has been felt in the cross-border payment sector. Traditional remittances remain notoriously slow and expensive, with the World Bank estimating the average fee for a money transfer at over 6%. Stablecoins slash these costs by removing the chain of intermediary correspondent banks.

A 2024 report by Cebr and BVNK projected that stablecoins could reduce settlement times by three to six days across major remittance corridors. This projection was realized in 2025 when businesses in emerging markets, particularly Brazil, India, and the Philippines, began using stablecoins for B2B trade settlement. For a small business in Jakarta paying a supplier in New York, a stablecoin payment is now faster and cheaper than a traditional wire transfer, providing instant liquidity that can be reinvested into operations. Such unlocking of trapped working capital is expected to drive further adoption as emerging market infrastructures continue to modernize.

At the same time, some operational challenges to more widespread adoption of stablecoin payments remain. The primary technical hurdle is fragmentation, as the current stablecoin ecosystem exists across dozens of blockchains. A user holding USDC on Ethereum cannot easily pay a merchant who accepts USDC on Solana without using a "bridge" or a swap, which introduces technical complexity and security risks.

Furthermore, the "last-mile" problem – the need to convert stablecoins back into local fiat currency to pay for real-world goods – remains a bottleneck in many jurisdictions. While the GENIUS Act eased these constraints in the U.S., many developing nations still lack the banking partnerships required for seamless on- and off-ramping. There is also the risk of "de-pegging" in which a stablecoin loses its 1:1 value due to reserve mismanagement or systemic shocks, as seen during the Silicon Valley Bank crisis in March 2023.

Looking toward 2027 and 2028, the programmability of stablecoins is poised to play a meaningful role in global commerce. Unlike traditional dollars, stablecoins can be embedded in smart contracts, allowing for conditional payments. For example, a logistics company's payment to a carrier could be automatically released the moment a GPS sensor confirms a delivery has arrived. This eliminates the need for escrow services and reduces the risk of non-payment, creating a more efficient global supply chain.

## Investment Thesis

**We are initiating coverage of OBOOK Holdings, Inc. (OWLS), which operates as OwlTing Group, with a Buy rating and a price target of \$11.**

**Moving up the value stack from gateway economics toward infrastructure economics.** OWLS is executing a strategic pivot from its e-commerce roots toward the "boring" but highly lucrative infrastructure of stablecoin settlement, on/off-ramps, and compliance-embedded payment services. The company is taking direct aim at the high-fee, slow-speed incumbents by targeting the \$230bn U.S. outbound remittance market with near-instant settlement at a fraction of the cost incurred by legacy providers.

**Visa Direct partnership provides immediate, scalable user base.** Visa Direct brings OWLS access to 11bn+ endpoints, 160 currencies, and 195+ countries and territories. This integration effectively turns every Visa debit card into a gateway for stablecoin liquidity while providing OWLS with an immediate, scalable user base that legacy crypto-native firms struggle to reach due to onboarding friction.

**Commercial traction beginning to show up in ways that matter.** OWLS needs to prove that enterprises want compliant fiat-to-stablecoin-to-fiat infrastructure, and the early evidence has been encouraging. The company announced that during 1Q26 it signed and onboarded





over 20 enterprise clients to OwlPay Harbor, including signed agreements and active onboarding processes, and that the annual payment volume represented by those clients' existing businesses exceeds \$5bn.

**Compliance-first positioning a major differentiator.** OWLS' regulatory footprint underpins its stablecoin payments initiatives. The company in January announced that its Nevada Money Transmitter License expanded its U.S. regulatory coverage to 41 states. Meanwhile, OWLS operates under a VASP license in the EU and under an Electronic Payment Intermediary Service Provider license in Japan, and it is pursuing additional licensing in Hong Kong, Singapore, and Latin America.

**Macro backdrop for stablecoin payments becoming more favorable.** Visa says retail-sized stablecoin volume across USDC, USDT, and PYUSD grew from \$0.5bn to \$69.8bn between 2019 and 2025, while DeFi Llama shows the current overall stablecoin market capitalization at almost \$300bn. Visa's own on-chain analytics and broader stablecoin research both point to a market that is steadily migrating away from purely speculative use cases and toward payments, treasury, and money-movement applications. In such an environment, a company like OWLS can benefit without having to predict which token wins or which blockchain dominates.

## Valuation

Our \$11 price target for OWLS is derived from a 5x EV/revenue multiple applied to our FY28E revenue estimate of \$200.3 million. We believe this valuation methodology appropriately captures the company's long-term growth trajectory while accounting for its current stage of scaling. By focusing on FY28, we are valuing the business based on a more mature state of its platform and market penetration.

Our use of a 5x multiple of forward revenue reflects a balanced assessment of OWLS' high-growth profile relative to its peer group and historical sector averages. We view this multiple as conservative, particularly given our expectation for significant margin expansion and operational leverage over the next three to five years.

While OWLS is currently prioritizing market share and revenue growth, its underlying unit economics suggest that profitability is likely to increase meaningfully as the business scales. As the company transitions toward consistently positive free cash flow, an EV/revenue-based valuation may understate the intrinsic value that an adjusted EBITDA-based approach would capture in the future.

## Risks

**Execution risk.** While OWLS has built a credible stablecoin payment infrastructure narrative, it still needs to convert signed clients and onboarding activity into recurring, scaled throughput. If deployment cycles stretch, corridors open more slowly than expected, or customers decide to keep volume with incumbent providers, then the company's monetization curve could disappoint.

**Regulatory risk.** OWLS' pursuit of additional licensing may take longer or cost more than expected, and stablecoin rules in major markets could evolve in ways that constrain economics, narrow product flexibility, or raise operating costs.

**Competition.** OWLS is not the only company trying to build regulated stablecoin infrastructure, as large Fintech firms, payment processors, and regional specialists are all moving in related directions. The company needs to prove it can carve out defensible niches where its licensing, product design, and integration depth give it a genuine edge.

**Macroeconomic risk.** Macroeconomic slowdowns could temper remittance flows, while integration challenges with legacy systems might slow enterprise adoption.

**Cybersecurity and data privacy risk.** OWLS is subject to evolving cyber threats, including potential unauthorized access, data breaches, or service disruptions, which could result in the loss of proprietary information, regulatory fines, and significant reputational damage.

## Management

**Darren Wang, Co-Founder and Chief Executive Officer.** Mr. Wang is the co-founder of OwlTing Group and has served as Chief Executive Officer since 2010. Before founding OwlTing, Mr. Wang worked at Google, Cyworld US, and Cywee Group. He subsequently earned a master's degree in electrical and computer engineering from Boston University, where he studied under Professor Lev Levitin, inventor of the Margolus-Levitin theorem.

**John Hsieh, Co-Founder and Chief Technology Officer.** Mr. Hsieh, who co-founded OWLS in 2010, serves as its Chief Technology Officer. He previously served as CTO of LGS (TaiwanGo) from 2004 to 2010 and has deep experience in programming, internet technology, and networking algorithms. Mr. Hsieh holds a bachelor's degree in bio-industrial mechatronics from National Taiwan University.

**Winnie Lin, Chief Financial Officer.** Ms. Lin has served as OWLS' CFO since September 2022. Prior to joining the company, she held positions at the Central Bank of Taiwan, LITE-ON Technology, Macquarie Capital Securities, McKinsey & Company, and Radium Life Technology between 2006 and 2019 in roles that involved policy, advisory, capital-markets, and operations. Ms. Lin holds a master's degree in finance and dual bachelor's degrees in business administration and accounting, all from National Taiwan University.

**Patrick Wang, Chief Business Officer.** Mr. Wang has served as OWLS' Chief Business Officer since December 2019. Before joining the company, he was Senior Manager at CyberTAN Technology from 2006 to 2011, and Department Manager at Advanced Semiconductor Engineering Holdings from 2013 to 2018. He holds a master's degree in international management from the University of London, SOAS, and a bachelor's degree in sociology from National Taipei University.

**Ryan Lin, Chief Compliance Officer.** Mr. Lin has served as OWLS' Chief Compliance Officer since May 2025. Prior to joining the company, he pursued an academic and public-service career. Mr. Lin is an Associate Professor and Director of the School of Financial Technology at Ming Chuan University and concurrently serves as an adjunct associate professor at Soochow University and National Chung Cheng University. He holds a Ph.D. in Law from National Taipei University, with academic focus areas spanning commercial and financial law, fintech regulation, and consumer protection. Mr. Lin's public roles have included serving as Director of the Financial Ombudsman Institution under Taiwan's Financial Supervisory Commission, Independent Director of China Television Corporation, and Committee Member of the FSC's Human Rights Working Group.





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As of March 31, 2026

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|------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|----------------------------|--------------|
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| <b>Hold</b>            | <b>71</b>             | <b>20.8%</b> | <b>7</b>                   | <b>2.0%</b>  |
| <b>Speculative Buy</b> | <b>12</b>             | <b>3.5%</b>  | <b>9</b>                   | <b>2.6%</b>  |
| <b>Sell</b>            | <b>0</b>              | <b>0.0%</b>  | <b>0</b>                   | <b>0.0%</b>  |

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**Buy:** Stock is expected to outperform the analyst's defined Sector/Industry Index\* over the following 6 to 12 months.

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| Company                      | Disclosure |
|------------------------------|------------|
| OBOOK Holdings, Inc. Class A | 3          |

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### Investment Risk

Risks to our thesis include execution risk, regulatory risks, competition, macroeconomic risks, and cybersecurity and data privacy risks.

### Valuation Methodology

Our \$11 price target for OWLS is based on a 5x EV/revenue multiple applied to our FY28E revenue of \$200.3m.

### Price Charts

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OWLS Rating History  
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